

SendKit vs Mailshake

The short version: Mailshake's pitch is simplicity, a rep sending on day one. It delivers that, at the cost of everything underneath: per-user pricing with hard mailbox caps (1, 2, or 10 per user), no sending infrastructure of its own, no placement testing, and an API dated 2017 that literally cannot launch a campaign without finishing a wizard in the UI. SendKit gives you the same day-one simplicity on real infrastructure, dedicated IPs, isolation, warmup, with a new-gen CLI + MCP where Mailshake has no automation story at all.

	SendKit	Mailshake
Sending infrastructure	Dedicated IPs and fully isolated sending on every plan, from \$99	None, sends through your own Gmail/Outlook/SMTP accounts
Pricing model	Flat platform price. Unlimited team members	Per user; each tier caps mail accounts per user at 1 / 2 / 10
Mailboxes	Unlimited	1 on Starter, 2 on Email Outreach, 10 on Sales Engagement; unlimited only on the contact-sales Agency plan
Email validation	Built in, every plan	Unlimited verification included, credit where due
Blacklist monitoring	Built in, real-time	Blacklist status monitoring included, credit where due
Inbox placement testing	Built in, every plan	Not offered
Warmup	Native: guardrails tuned per mailbox type, plus a high-quality seed pool used only with your mailboxes	Unlimited warmup included; mechanism undisclosed beyond "via SMTP"
Health controls	Per-mailbox visibility, auto-pause when health drops	Failover only inside the paid mailbox add-on; no per-mailbox health scoring published
API + CLI + MCP	Extensive APIs with smart routing, 5-10x higher rate limits, plus hosted MCP and CLI	2017-era API that cannot launch campaigns (UI wizard required), 5,000 recipients per campaign cap, hourly quota units. No CLI, no MCP
White-label	Full, from \$499: reports, login, URL, API, logo, colors	Not offered

WHAT YOU GET WITH SENDKIT THAT MAILSHAKE DOESN'T HAVE

- **An actual sending layer.** Dedicated IPs and isolated infrastructure on every plan, Mailshake rides entirely on your own account reputations.
- **Inbox placement testing.** Test inbox vs spam placement before each campaign. Absent on Mailshake.
- **Unlimited mailboxes without seat math.** Mailshake meters senders per paid user (1, 2, or 10); scaling means buying users or \$12/month domain packs.
- **Per-mailbox auto-pause.** Mailshake's protection is a failover inside a paid add-on; SendKit watches and acts on every mailbox's health.

- **New-gen CLI + MCP connection.** Run campaigns, leads, replies, reports, and a hundred other things from the same interface, Claude, your terminal, or your own scripts. Mailshake's 2017 API can't even start a campaign without a human finishing the wizard in the UI.
- **Full white-label.** Reports, login screen, URL, API, logo, and colors carry your brand. Not offered on Mailshake at any tier.
- **AI reply agent.** Reads and tags every reply, auto-responds above your confidence threshold, Mailshake's AI writes copy (SHAKESpeare); reply handling stays manual.
- **Real scale headroom.** No 5,000-recipients-per-campaign cap, no monthly API recipient quota, no 1,500-sends-per-month starter ceiling.

CLEAR EXPECTATIONS: WHAT YOU GET

- Low bounce rate and better deliverability
- Better time to lead from the reply agent and reply system
- Better white-label report system and custom GTM reporting
- Better inbox pricing and diversification across Google, Microsoft, and Azure mailboxes
- Better scaled pricing on higher volumes. The platform is made for scale
- Better advanced settings for sending management
- Faster inbox loading for faster time to lead
- Unlimited workspaces and team members with custom roles
- A way clearer, easier platform, built for heavy Claude users

WHERE MAILSHAKE IS STRONG: Ease of onboarding is real, reps genuinely send on day one. The \$99 tier bundles a power dialer with 5 phone numbers and unlimited North America minutes, and unlimited warmup + unlimited verification are included on every plan.

WHAT MAILSHAKE USERS REPORT

G2 4.7/5 ACROSS 273 REVIEWS, FULL CORPUS MINED 2026-07-12; TRUSTPILOT 4.8/5; TRUSTRADIUS

- On G2, pricing (24 mentions) and limits (17) lead the dislikes: "A lower-priced tier with limited sending would be helpful."
- Reviews run largely positive; the recurring gripes are workflow ceilings: "can't update a contact's email without creating a new contact"; "you have to manually configure sending calendars and turn campaigns on and off"; "lacks some of the more advanced flow features"; CRM sync "only with Zapier (extra steps and costs)."

Switching takes about 30 minutes. API key in, campaigns, sequences, and leads transfer automatically. Most teams finish in about 30 minutes. Mailboxes bought through InboxKit move in one step. Want the step-by-step? Ask for the **Cold Email Platform Migration Kit**.

[Bring your setup to a live demo](#)

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Comparing other platforms too? We keep the same honest head-to-heads for **Smartlead, Instantly, EmailBison, Lemlist, Apollo**, and more, reply and name the platform, and we'll send that one over. Also useful: **Why SendKit** (the full picture) and **State of Cold Email 2026** (the benchmark data behind these numbers).